



deeply about transforming the problem to match it to improve the overall value proposition. If the purpose of travel is to meet colleagues in office and discuss some work with them, you may offer a Zoom or Skype-like solution.

The fact of the matter is, when you attempt to compete with a disruptive innovation using another disruptive innovation, there is little room to wiggle out sustenance. So, most companies trying to do so end up playing a catch-up game with the disruptors.

Change in perspective

While others are going at disruptive innovation, understand the landscape and think: How can you transform the business model, customer problem, or the value proposition of the entire industry itself? How can you pioneer something so transformative that disruptive innovation becomes irrelevant?

When you start to think about tomorrow and over-morrow, that is, the day after tomorrow, your strategy changes radically. For most businesses, digital transformation is overdue; I suggest you get over with it. However, all the others need to understand that it is not the end. You must progress beyond it and start thinking about problem transformation.

This level of innovation, in my view, is transformative, and hence it is apt to call it 'Transformative Innovation!'

Businesses must progress beyond

business transformation and start thinking about problem transformation.

Are you still trying to make a better hammer or have started making a drill machine? Perhaps you should, instead, start focusing on how you can help your customers make a hole in the wall.

But think again: Did you want to help your customers display beautiful pictures on their walls? Depending on how you see it, what you do will change significantly.

After all, why would someone make a hole in the wall when they can use removable stickers?

People who used taxis before shifted to Uber *et al* for their urban commute, which significantly covered (about 65%) office going population. However, when this working

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population starts to work from anywhere, they will not need to use taxis much. Instead, they will use Zoom, Skype, or MS-Teams, eliminating or reducing the need for taxis significantly.

This change will morph the competitive landscape, and you will find Uber and others competing for the customer's wallet share with Zoom and others.

Disruptive innovation was a solution to supersede incremental innovation and compete with incumbents. Transformative innovation is about problem transformation, which changes the game and makes disruptive innovation almost irrelevant.

The point

When my son and I were playing, we intended to entertain ourselves. When he realised that he was being outsmarted, he transformed his problem. He changed the game and levelled the playing field by staying focused on our intent.

You can also transform and change the game, but only if you think two steps ahead of disruptors. If you want to do that, you must shift your focus from customers' problems to customers' intents. When you respond to those intents in the best way you can, you will stay ahead of the curve!

So, how do you embrace transformative innovation? Well, that is the topic for our next few articles. But here are some pre-requisites. You need to acknowledge these distinctions and accept that you are going to need incremental and efficiency innovation.

However, most organisations are not designed for the third type of innovation, that is, disruptive innovation. So, when they attempt doing that, they look like a dad dancing at a teenager's party.

Leave disruptive innovation to the startups. Instead, you change the game while they are busy changing the business model. **EFY**



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